Submission of Abstract and full paper

Those who are interested in presenting papers are requested to submit their abstract and full paper in the designated themes in about 500 and 2500 – 3000 words respectively. The abstract and full paper should be sent to the Convener in both soft and hard copy on or before 30th October 2014.

Convener
Dr. K.R.Murugan
Associate Professor & Head i/c
Department of Women's Studies
Alagappa University,
Karaikudi - 630 003.
E-mail - dws.alukkdi@gmail.com

Selected research papers to be presented in the Conference would be published in the form of Conference Proceedings with full text of the papers with ISBN on the day of the Conference.

Late submission of papers will not be entertained.

The paper should contain the following components:

Title (in Block Letters) Name of the author with designation, postal address and email address, **Font size** – 12, **Font style** – Times New Roman, **Line Space** – 1.5

Registration Fee

The Registration Form for the Conference is attached with the brochure. Participants are expected to send the form duly filled in, along with the registration fee.

Faculties	: Rs.500
Research Scholars	: Rs.300

Mode of Payment

1 Only demand drafts will be accepted. (Cheques / Cash / Money orders will not be accepted)

2 The DD should be drawn in favour of The Convener, **NCSSW-2014**, Alagappa University, Karaikudi.

Local Hospitality

Local hospitality of all the participants will be taken care of by the organizing committee.

Accommodation

Upon special request, accommodation will be arranged in hotels on payment.

Contact for enquiries:

Department of Women's Studies
Alagappa University
Karaikudi.
Phone : 04565-224 615, 223 230

Conference Coordinators:

Ms. P.Veeramani

Dr. N.K.Bhuvaneswari

Dr. S.Poulpunitha

Dr. D.Thirumalraja

NATIONAL CONFERENCE ON

SAFETY AND SECURITY OF WOMEN AND GIRLS IN PUBLIC SPACES: PLANNING AND DESIGNING MECHANISMS

(NCSSW-2014)

4th - 5th December, 2014

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DEPARTMENT OF WOMEN'S STUDIES

ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

KARAIKUDI – 630 003

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ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

Alagappa University was established in the year May 1985 by a Special Act of Government of Tamil Nadu, with the objective of fostering research and dissemination of knowledge in various branches of learning. The University is named after Padma Bhushan (Late) Dr. R.M. Alagappa Chettiar. It is recognized by University Grants Commission and member of Association of Indian Universities as well as member of Association of Common wealth Universities. It has the motto of "EXCELLENCE IN ACTION" and keeps the vision of excellence in all spheres of education. It has 10 Schools comprising 23 departments, 6 Centres and 2 Constituent Colleges and 37 affiliated colleges in the revenue district of Sivagangai and Ramanathapuram. The University is reaccredited with 'A' grade by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council.

The Host Institution

The Department of Women's Studies was started in 1988, the first of its kind in the country in a general university. The Department offers Post Graduate, M.Phil., and Ph.D., Programmes in Women's Studies since its inception. A multi-pronged approach is called for all at levels in developing, strengthening, harnessing the female resource of the country. Women's Studies despite being the most unconventional and a new entrant into academic, is simultaneously a discourse, a methodology and an agenda for action. Alagappa University has Department of Women's Studies and Centre for Women's Studies with symbiotic relationship.

Courses offered by the Department

- M.A. Gender Studies
- M.Phil. in Women's Studies
- Ph.D. in Women's Studies
- Master of Social Work
- Ph.D. in Social Work
- Credit papers offered to other Departments under CBCS
  - Introduction to Gender Studies
  - Life Skills Education
- Certificate Course in SHG Management (through DDE)
- Certificate Course in Beauty Therapy
- Certificate Course in Gender Studies
- Certificate Course in Guidance and Counseling
- Certificate Course in NGO Management
- PG Diploma in Beauty Therapy
- PG Diploma in Gender Studies

Background of the Conference

Women and girls are frequently subject to violence and abuse from physical and verbal harassment to assault and rape on cities streets, public transportation or in their own neighbourhoods. Such daily occurrences limit the rights and freedom of women as equal citizens to enjoy their neighbourhoods and cities.Women and girls experience various types of sexual violence in public spaces from sexual harassment to sexual assault. It happens on streets, public transport and parks, in and around schools and workplaces, in public sanitation system and in their own neighbourhood. This reality reduces women's and girls' freedom of movement. It reduces their ability to participate in school, work and in public life. It limits their access to essential services, and enjoyment of cultural and recreational opportunities. It also negatively impacts their health and well-being.

Although violence in the private domain is now widely recognized as a human rights violation, violence against women and girls, especially harassment in public spaces, remains a largely neglected issue, with some laws or policies in place to prevent and address it. Safety planning and designing mechanism for women and girls is important which is the need of the hour. Harassment and abuse of women and girls in public spaces is a rampant yet largely neglected issue. This National Conference provides guidance on how to create safety and security for women and girls to live a life free of violence. Also, this Conference is organized with an aim to of make the participants aware of specific aspects of safety and security in different environments.

Subthemes of the Conference

- Forms of Abuse
- Consequences of Abuse
- Safety Awareness
- Self Defense Strategies
- Safety and Security Needs
- Legal Provisions
- Safety Planning & Designing Mechanisms
- Social, Economic and Cultural Dimensions for women safety